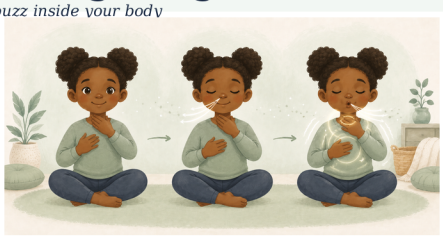
1

CALMING & CONNECTION

Humming Song

Feel the buzz inside your body



1. Put one hand on your chest and one hand on your throat. These are your vibration detectors.
2. Take a slow breath in through your nose.
3. Hum your favorite song as you breathe out. Any song works! Feel the buzzing under your hands — that vibration is waking up your vagus nerve.
4. Hum for 5 full breaths. Try humming lower — deep hums make stronger vibrations. Notice how your chest and belly feel warm and tingly.

Little Roots Foundation

littlerootsfoundation.org

Try this when: You feel disconnected, lonely, or need comfort.

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2

QUICK CALM-DOWN

Cold Water Reset

Wake up your body's chill switch



1. Go to a sink and turn on the cold water. Not freezing — just cool.
2. Cup the cold water in your hands and gently splash it on your cheeks and forehead. This triggers your body's "dive reflex" — a built-in calm button!
3. Hold a cold, wet washcloth against your face for 15 seconds. Take slow breaths while you hold it there.
4. Notice what changed. Your heart might feel slower. Your body might feel less hot. That's your vagus nerve doing its job.

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Try this when: You feel overheated, panicky, or your heart is pounding fast.

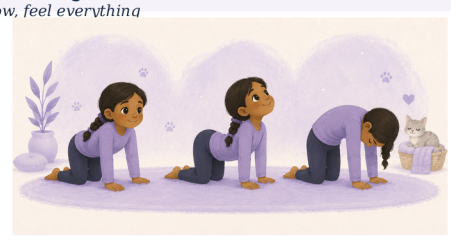
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3

TENSION RELEASE

Stretchy Cat

Move slow, feel everything



1. Get on your hands and knees like a cat. Spread your fingers wide on the floor.
2. Breathe in and drop your belly down, lift your head up, and look at the ceiling. You're a happy, stretchy cat.
3. Breathe out and round your back up like a scared cat. Tuck your chin to your chest. Push the floor away with your hands.
4. Go back and forth 8 times. Move as slowly as you can — slower is better. Match every movement to a breath.

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Try this when: Your body feels tight, stiff, or locked up from sitting too long.

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4

BIG EMOTIONS

Lion's Roar

Open wide and let it out



1. Sit up tall on your knees or cross-legged. Put your hands on your knees and spread your fingers wide like lion claws.
2. Take a huge breath in through your nose. Fill up your whole chest.
3. Open your mouth as wide as you can, stick your tongue ALL the way out, look up at the ceiling, and breathe out with a loud "HAAAA!" — roar like a lion!
4. Do 4 big roars. The stretch in your jaw and throat activates your vagus nerve. Finish with 2 quiet breaths — the lion is resting now.

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Try this when: You feel frustrated, stuck, or like you're holding something in.

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5

SAFETY & COMFORT

Butterfly Hug

Your own wings, your own calm



1. Cross your arms over your chest so each hand rests on the opposite shoulder. Hook your thumbs together — those are your butterfly's antennae.
2. Close your eyes or look softly at the floor. Take one slow breath in.
3. Start gently tapping — left, right, left, right — like a butterfly flapping its wings. Keep it slow and steady. Breathe normally.
4. Keep tapping for 1 full minute. Think of a place where you feel safe and happy. The tapping tells both sides of your brain: "You are okay."

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Try this when: You feel scared, overwhelmed, or need to feel safe.

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6

FOCUS & RESET

Magic Ear Rub

Tiny touch, big calm



1. Use your thumb and pointer finger to gently grab the outside rim of one ear at the very top.
2. Slowly rub and roll your way down from the top of your ear to the earlobe. Press gently — like you're rubbing a good luck charm.
3. When you reach your earlobe, give it a gentle squeeze and hold for 3 seconds. There are special nerve endings here connected to your vagus nerve.
4. Do both ears 3 times each. Breathe slowly the whole time. Your ears might feel warm when you're done — that means it's working!

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Try this when: You need to focus, feel antsy, or want a calm-down you can do anywhere.

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